

Window Grille

From the library of Sultan Baybars al-Jashankir on al-Mu'izz Street

Bahri Mamluk, 708-09 AH / 1309-10 CE

W: 61 cm; H: 186 cm

Inv. no. 3512

Window grille in two sections; the larger executed in the mangur technique. The lower panel features a version of the traditional mafruka, or hooked cross motif. The grille was originally part of the library of Baybars al-Jashankir (708-09 AH /1309-10 CE) within his complex on al-Mu'izz Street; designs of this kind were once common across both religious and secular architecture in medieval Cairo, with notable examples in the ribat of Ahmad ibn Sulayman al- Rifa'i (690-91 AH / 1291 CE), the madrasa of Qatlubugha al-Dhahabi (747-48 AH / 1347 CE), and the Hanging Church, among others.